

The multifunction steering wheel also integrates all of the infotainment services into the MID, which makes operations even easier. Additionally, you get body-coloured inserts and a premium, all-leather black upholstery, with spacious, electrically operated front seats (that are also heated – no cooling). The rear seats are spacious enough to accommodate two adults for short journeys in reasonable comfort. The dual-zone AC, while being powerful enough, is a tad noisy, breaking the momentum of seamless comfort.

The Beetle is an easy car to drive, and more enthusiastic drivers will be left wanting for more. The light steering wheel is easy to maneuver, and the soft suspension sits the car squat on the ground. It does get slightly unsettled by large bumps, but most drivers of the Beetle will enjoy the easy-flowing driving nature of the car.

The Beetle is not about sporty drives, and neither does it aim to be. It is all about arriving somewhere in ample style and comfort, and the VW Beetle aces both its objectives with class.

BMW X3: The sporty SUV for the enthusiast's family

Every BMW with the 'M' badge is a formidable offering, and the BMW X3 xDrive 30d M Sport is no different. If you're thinking of a well-optimised luxury SUV that is comfortable, fun and engaging on long journeys, the BMW X3 has a lot to offer.

To begin with, BMW's iDrive infotainment unit uses a 12.3-inch non-touch display that is recessed to enhance sunlight visibility. Alongside the standard multimedia options, you get excellent in-car audio fidelity and surround effects, and full control of your audio via the equaliser settings provided. Connectivity options include Bluetooth, USB, aux, SD card and CD drive, and the iDrive controller retains its fluid touchpad to make searches easier.

You also get full phone and message controls, along with a 3D sat-nav map that knows Indian roads fairly well. The high definition rear parking camera, coupled with auto-adaptive, electrochromic rear view mirrors are excellent to assist reversing in tight spots. The console is a joy to use, based on sheer fluidity and ease of usage. Add to that, a gorgeous digital MID that shows every notification and update possible, including gate open, date, temperature and more.

The plush black interiors and the panoramic sunroof add class, and the incredibly comfortable front seats also add extra thigh support for tall drivers. You also get cooled storage compartments, and a large, airy cabin that makes the rear row great to be in. Sitting on the rear row also provides

good ground stability, and you can really feel the car's weight impacting its stability positively.

The BMW X3 xDrive 30d M Sport offers good, enjoyable driving dynamics. The steering wheel is weighed slightly lesser than our choice, but many would enjoy the zippy maneuverability despite the car's size. Hit the highway and switch to Sport, and this is where you get to know the real DNA of BMW's mid-sized luxury beast, the X3 xDrive 30d M Sport.

Skoda Superb: Backseat comforts

Of the four cars we drove this month, the MINI Cooper D is all about beautiful, ambient lighting and excellent handling, while the VW Beetle is about ease of driving and iconic styling. The BMW X3, meanwhile, is about a mean riding stance and great highway power. Amid all of these, the all-new Skoda Superb holds its own by being literally superb itself.



It retains the same SmartLink infotainment system seen in the Beetle, including all infotainment services but a sat-nav unit. You get ventilated seats, special Canton-powered 8.1-channel audio that is deep, crisp and clear, an automatic sunroof, adaptive mirrors, a thorough MID, voice control and easy coasting that still makes the rather massive sedan quite fuel efficient. Coupled with coasting, our peak mileage on journeys came up to 20kph, which is impressive. While there is a slight turbo lag, the engine is still powerful, and there is ample torque to never let you feel out of depth on the highway. The steering is well-weighted, but still retains Skoda's easily maneuverable characteristic that makes driving the large saloon quite comfortable even in tight city traffic.

The Laurin & Klement edition gets special leather upholstery, sunlight shades on rear windows, a blue/white/green ambient LED strip and inlay lighting to make the cabin feel special. Alongside, the rear seats get acres of leg and knee room, enough headroom and decent thigh support as well, falling short of perfect seat depth by a whisker. The ride quality is smooth, stable and pliant, and reinstates the fact that the Skoda Superb is a fantastic car to be chauffeured around in. You also get rear AC temperature control, and knobs to adjust the front passenger seat for optimum legroom.

The new Skoda Superb has loads of features to please the discerning buyer. Hosting a plush cabin, great ride quality and an efficiently tuned engine, it's worthy enough to compete against the two luxury hybrids including Toyota Camry and Honda Accord, toe-to-toe. 

